

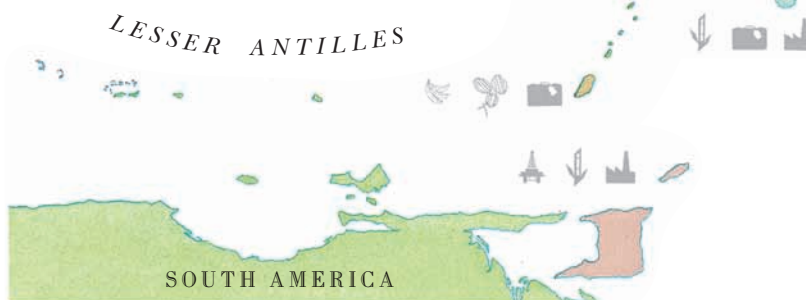


PITCH LAKE

La Brea, in the south of Trinidad, boasts one of the world's most unusual sights. Near the town is a lake filled not with water, but with natural pitch, a black, sticky tar that is mainly used for surfacing roads. The lake, which is 200 ft (60 m) deep, is the world's largest single supply of natural pitch. It is thought to be linked to the underground rocks that supply nearby South America with oil.

INDUSTRY

The most industrialized country in the area is Trinidad and Tobago, which has petrochemical, iron, and steel industries based on its reserves of oil and natural gas. Aside from Barbados, the other islands have few mineral resources and rely on bananas, sugar, cotton, and cocoa for export. In recent years, all the islands have tried to produce a wider range of exports. St. Vincent now has a flour mill, and Martinique an oil refinery. Light industrial parks have been set up on a number of islands.



LESSER ANTILLES INDUSTRIES

ANTIGUA AND BARBUDA
Tourism, cotton, rum
ST. KITTS AND NEVIS
Sugar, cotton production, tourism
DOMINICA
Bananas, citrus fruits, essential oils
ST. LUCIA
Bananas, tourism, electrical parts
ST. VINCENT AND THE GRENADINES
Tourism, bananas, food processing, cement
BARBADOS
Sugar, tourism, petroleum products
GRENADA
Tourism, bananas, nutmeg
TRINIDAD AND TOBAGO
Oil refining, chemicals, sugar



This steel band is playing music for tourists in Tobago.

ISLAND MUSIC

Almost every Caribbean island resounds with the beat of calypso music, which has its origins in the slave songs brought from West Africa. Calypso has a strong beat and lyrics about social and political problems. In recent years *soca*, a mixture of soul and calypso, has started to become popular with younger people.

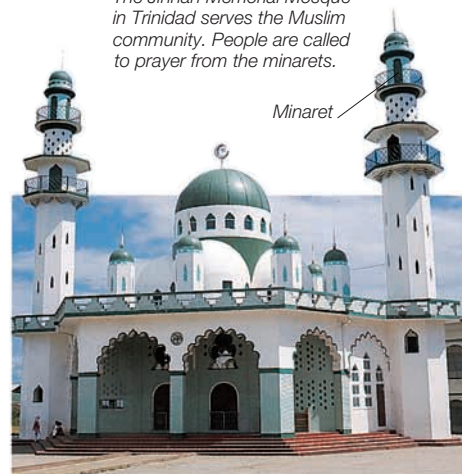
Steel band music originated in Trinidad, using pans or drums made from large oil drums.

ISLAND SPICES

The island of Grenada is the world's second largest producer of nutmeg, after Indonesia, and grows almost one-quarter of the world's total crop. Nutmeg, a spice used to flavor food, originated in the East Indies, and was introduced to Grenada by the Dutch in the 19th century. The trees flourished in the fertile volcanic soil, warm temperatures, and high annual rainfall. Ginger, cinnamon, pepper, and cloves are also grown on the island.



The Jinnah Memorial Mosque in Trinidad serves the Muslim community. People are called to prayer from the minarets.



PEOPLE OF THE CARIBBEAN

Most people who live on the islands are a mixture of descendants of African slaves, Europeans, and local Carib Indians. The exception are the people of Trinidad, where almost 40 percent of the population is originally from the Indian subcontinent. Shipped over to work in the plantations, the immigrants brought their religions with them, setting up Hindu temples and Muslim mosques and continuing to observe their own religious customs.

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